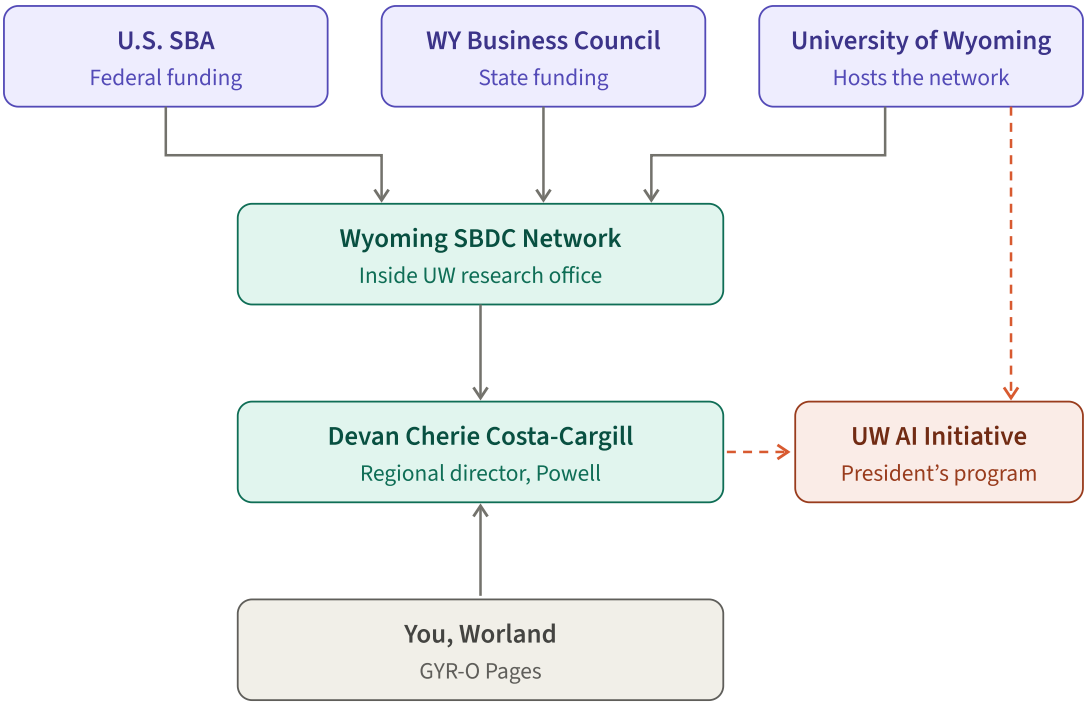
Wyoming SBDC: who funds it, and the UW connection

How Devan Cherie Costa-Cargill's office connects to the University of Wyoming



Solid arrows: the money and the organization. The SBA funds the network through a cooperative agreement, the Wyoming Business Council adds state funds, and UW hosts it under the Office of Research and Economic Development.
Dashed arrows: the connection to make. The AI Initiative is a separate UW program run from the President's office; Devan Cherie, inside the same university, can make the introduction.

What "hosting" means

- **The University holds the federal agreement.** The SBA signs its cooperative agreement with a host organization, usually a university, rather than with the network itself. In Wyoming that host is UW, and the network sits under its Office of Research and Economic Development.
- **The staff are University employees.** Hence Devan Cherie's uwyo.edu address: her paycheck, office systems and email come through UW, though she works from Powell.
- **The host must match the federal money.** Federal law requires at least one non-federal dollar for each SBA dollar; the Wyoming Business Council's state funds and UW's own contributions supply it.
- **The host runs the business side:** accounting, reporting to the SBA, hiring, and the regional offices around the state.

These are the general rules of the national SBDC program; not every Wyoming detail has been confirmed.

Source: UW News, "New $2.5 Million Grant to Help Wyoming Entrepreneurs Access Critical Resources" (November 2021), uwyo.edu. The arrangement may have changed since.